

Role of Digital Marketing Content Strategy on User Experience Toward Cultural Venues in Saudi Arabia

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ABSTRACT

The noticed cultural shift in Saudi Arabia is manifested in the digital platforms on social media networks. Consumers of cultural products encounter these creative institutions online, and digital cultural experience takes a further direction through digital content creation. Thus, this expansion and growing online cultural content lead institutions to apply different digital content strategies and tactics to reach and deliver an effective user experience. Therefore, this research explored the user experience of cultural content and identified the patterns of effective digital marketing content strategy in this field by reviewing recent quantitative analysis and content analysis and proposing the best practices. The study revealed that digital content that is inviting in the form of Call-To-Action, aesthetically appealing, and tells a story in a local tone can significantly influence users' overall engagement. The research has shed light on Saudi Arabia's unique cultural context and how digital marketing strategies and content creators should be tailored to resonate with the local audience. The contribution of this research is reflected in providing a rich and comprehensive understanding of the phenomena, equipping managers of cultural venues, digital marketers, content creators, and social media developers in Saudi Arabia to develop user-centric and culturally relevant content strategies that enhance the digital experience overall.

Keywords

Content Marketing Strategy, User Experience, Engagement, Cultural Marketing, Call-To-Action, Storytelling, Aesthetic, Localization.

1. Introduction

Saudi Arabia's cultural scene is currently undergoing a significant transformation. This change is driven by the Vision 2030 initiative, which aims to embrace and nurture the country's cultural heritage while welcoming new forms of artistic narratives as one of the critical indicators of quality of life.

In addition, investing in different forms of culture is a top priority to the strategic objectives of the Ministry of Culture, which was established in 2018. Their main objective is to seek cultural diversity and richness through 16 cultural sectors, including visual arts, theatre, fashion, architecture and design, museums, libraries, literature, and cultural events. One of the Ministry of Culture initiatives is Literary Partner, which aims to expand cultural awareness in society through cooperation with local cafes. Many servicescapes are becoming hubs for cultural activities, from arts and crafts work and book fairs to literary gatherings.

This cultural shift is also manifested in the digital existence of cultural venues on the web and social media networks. Consumers of cultural products encounter these creative institutions

online, and digital cultural experience takes a further direction through digital content creation. Thus, this expansion and growing online cultural content lead institutions to apply different digital content strategies and tactics to reach and deliver an effective user experience.

Therefore, this research aims to explore the user experience of cultural content and identify patterns of effective digital marketing content strategy in this field by reviewing recent quantitative and content analysis, identifying key data gaps, and proposing best practices related to content marketing strategies.

2. Literature Review

2.1 Content Marketing Strategy

In today's marketplace, the success of a digital marketing strategy depends significantly on the quality of its digital content (Baltes, 2015, cited in Krowinska et al., 2023). Content has been identified as anything users may consume while browsing a digital platform, whether an image, a context or a video. However, this content must be planned and designed in a strategic way in order to deliver its mission and meet the organization's objective (Krowinska et al., 2023). More specifically, content could be defined as any placeholder for everything customers interact with on the digital channel. Far from the classical 4 Ps of marketing strategy framework, the seven Ps have been shaped to include pages reflecting the content. However, the effectiveness of content depends on how well it is distributed digitally (Kingsnorth, 2016). Content creation can be considered as a sort of asset for the business, as it contributes to the shareholder value. Many advantages has been discussed in the literature regarding to crafting qualified digital content. Research by Rowley (2010), noted that digital content marketing could be more valuable once there is a high engagement from the consumer's side. Through analysis of several websites with different digital contents, findings showed that the customer's experience of digital content requires the participation of customers in learning and acting as co-creators in the experience (Rowley, 2010).

Digital content plays a fundamental role in modern marketing strategies. In particular, it is vital to present high-quality content by analysing the target segment and the right approach to promote this content. It eases the reach and engagement with the target customers. So, unlike traditional media, which is limited scope, digital platforms offer a vast audience base. The success of online communication depends on high-quality content that captures attention, drives qualified traffic (Baltes, 2015), and augments consumer digital experience (Lou & Xie, 2021). In addition, interactive content can boost customer engagement and builds trust and credibility (Hollebeek & Macky, 2018). It has been argued that content marketing boasts approximately six times higher conversion rates than other digital methods. Engaging content leads users toward desired actions, such as signing up, purchasing, or subscribing. A positive relationship has been found between effective content and conversion rates (Ludwig et al., 2013).

2.2 Content Tactics

Content marketing focuses on the perceptual and artistic aspects of marketing. It is a more customer-oriented activity customized to the targeted segment's interests. Content creation has core guides in what has been called content architecture (Kotler, Cao & Wang, 2020). High-quality content represents a strategy that involves several content tactics that suit the objectives and goals of organizations.

A range of digital content tactics have been found to impact user experience in various ways. Sundar (2014) identified that different on-screen interaction techniques, such as clicking, sliding, and zooming, can influence user engagement and memory. Kim (2011) further emphasized the importance of these interaction factors in digital content, showing that they can affect users' flow and use intention. The relevance and content quality of a website were highlighted by Damir (2020) as key factors in influencing user engagement behaviors. Lastly, Pantano (2010) discussed the potential of digital content management in improving consumers' experience, particularly in the retail context. These studies underscore the significant impact of digital content tactics on user experience, with implications for engagement, memory, and use intention.

2.2.1 Storytelling

The concept of storytelling is regarded as the core of human communication (Fisher, 1987). In the modern marketplace, businesses thrive on digital platforms to get consumers' attention, with massive exposure to content and various advertisements. Storytelling is a profound marketing strategy that adds meaning to interactions and transforms transactions into relationships (Brough, 2024). The power of the narrative nature of storytelling extends to be a form of connection between the brand and its target segment. In order to add depth and inviting factors to storytelling content, it should include four elements: characters, setting, conflict, plot, and resolution (Brough, 2024).

The importance of storytelling strategy is reflected in creating meaningful connections, from crafting compelling stories to integrating them into social media marketing. For storytelling strategy to be integrated and effective, creators should understand emerging relevant technologies in the digital landscape. However, the challenge is to make the audience inspired and attached to these stories (Palusen, 2021)

Storytelling in marketing strategy is a crucial but often overlooked aspect of sense-making and decision-making processes (Ardley, 2006). It can be a powerful tool for mediating brand identity and communicating values, lifestyles, and emotions (Erkas & Baron, 2007). Furthermore, storytelling can be extended beyond advertising to add meaning to products, enhancing brand image and equity (Dias & Dias, 2018). A study by Ciancia (2020) found that implementing a storytelling strategy helps promote social values and activate change in brand communication. Moreover, incorporating social issues in communication campaigns drives sustainable social change (Ciancia, 2020).

Considering the impact of story content on engagement, research consistently demonstrates the significant impact of storytelling on consumer engagement. Kemp et al. (2021) and Dessart & Pitardi (2019) both highlight the positive relationship between story content and emotional connection, with the latter emphasizing the role of the story plot, characters, and verisimilitude in triggering cognitive, emotional, and behavioral responses. A further study showed that digital video storytelling ads are more effective in hooking viewers and generating positive digital engagement compared to argumentative ads (Coker, Flight & Baima, 2021). However, further research presents a contrasting view, suggesting that the use of storytelling in information visualizations may not necessarily increase user engagement (Boy, Detienne & Fekete, 2015).

These studies collectively highlight the importance of storytelling in marketing, not only for creating a compelling brand narrative but also for influencing consumer engagement.

2.2.2 Call-To-Action

A call-to-action (CTA) strategy is a digital marketing strategy that prompts customers to do some acts, like placing an order, signing up for a newsletter, or visiting a web page (Kumar, 2021).

Previous studies have examined the impact of CTAs in content marketing strategies. Handayani et al. (2018) demonstrated that CTA buttons in Instagram posts significantly influence consumers' impulsive purchases but are less compelling to improving consumers' perceived enjoyment. More research on CTA marketing strategies has highlighted the importance of incentives and customer characteristics in direct mailings (Vafainia, Breugelmans & Bijmolt, 2019). Video format and a "shop now" CTA have been found to increase advertising recognition compared to other approaches (Chen, Yeh & Chang, 2020). However, the adoption of CTA by users depends on certain factors, including perceived ease of use, usefulness, compatibility, and subjective norm (Peng et al., 2014). A recent study by Dindar (2024) considers the impact of Instagram CTA posts on consumer behavioral intentions. He found that the urgency and clarity of CTAs positively shaped users' attitudes toward promotional messages and increased their purchasing intentions (Dindar, 2024).

Considering the impact of CTAs on engagement, several studies have shown that various types of CTA messages on Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter can drive attitudinal and behavioral engagement. However, overall engagement was found to be low when corporate social responsibility messages encouraged further conversations, and multiple CTAs within one post decreased engagement (Chae, 2021). Another research found that consumers are more likely to click, like, comment, and share a post if it includes CTA and rich media components. Thus, CTAs augment all four engagement behaviours (Moran, Muzellec & Johnson, 2020). Shilovsky (2021) extends this to include employee engagement by implementing CTA content in social networks, as they are considered a part of the brand community (Shilovsky, 2021).

2.2.3 Aesthetic Design

In early literature, the term aesthetic evolved philosophically, especially in the context of art research (Csikszentmihalyi & Robinson, 1990). The scope of the term has been expanded to different disciplines, including marketing and product design. Aesthetic dimension design refers to the characteristics of content that are visually appealing and pleasing to all human senses. The current literature uncovered various attributes of aesthetics that are not only for the appeal of tangible products but also intangible and digital visual content. Baisya and Das (2008) identified aesthetic elements in marketing as visual, auditory, olfactory, and ergonomics. (Baisya & Das, 2008). Although there are limited scales to measure aesthetic design, some scales do not measure it in isolation but include its determinants, such as novelty and ambiguity (Zhang et al., 2021). Blijlevens et al. (2017) developed a scale of five items, highlighting beauty, attractiveness, and pleasure factors while simultaneously capturing the construct of aesthetics (Blijlevens et al., 2017).

In marketing, aesthetic design plays a crucial role in influencing consumer behavior, purchase intentions (Hagtvedt, 2023; Baisya & Das, 2008), user responses (David & Glore, 2010), user experience (Mahlke, 2008), perceived utility (Jiang et al., 2016) and user satisfaction (Lindgaard, 2007). The aesthetic middle principle suggests that moderately attractive and solid

designs or moderately strong are most effective in generating purchase intentions (Giese et al., 2014). This principle is particularly relevant for hedonic products and in the absence of product-related information. Aesthetics and design can also significantly impact consumer experience and behavior in the hospitality industry, particularly in hedonistic consumer groups (Alfakhri et al., 2017).

Aesthetic design positively affects consumers' desire to express themselves and develops their intention to engage on social media. However, this depends on the consumer's level of aesthetic perceptual ability (Zhang et al., 2021). Moreover, the consumers' aesthetic value is considered a key driver of social media use, as it generates responses such as consumer inspiration (Aljukhadar, Poirier, & Senecal, 2020). Regarding aesthetic content in social media and its impact on user engagement, it has been established that content aesthetic quality affects customer engagement and accordingly boosts brand love in content marketing of luxury fashion brands (Bazi, Filieri & Gorton, 2023).

2.2.4 Localized content

Localized content is pivotal in digital marketing, offering businesses unique advantages in today's interconnected market. Recently, more attention is paid to locally oriented social media content. Regarding cultural relevance, cultural differences matter in a globalized landscape. Localized content considers cultural sensitivities, traditions, and values, helping brands avoid potentially offensive or tone-deaf messaging. Alshoaibi (2021) states that the degree of cultural adaptation of web content impacts customers' perception of the site's effectiveness. While some consumers prefer localized web content in culturally different areas, some countries prefer localized web content. This emphasizes that businesses need to develop proper content strategies in social media to be effective and create a solid brand image (Alshoaibi, 2021).

In addition, when content speaks directly to the local audience, it conveys authenticity in meeting their needs (Mehta, 2020). It has been established that localized social media use driven by social motivations significantly affects interpersonal trust and local participation (Kwon, Shao & Nah, 2020).

Hochman and Manovich (2013) have raised a question in their research about how social media platforms reflect local content of social activities and further cultural patterns in specific locations. Through conducting a visual cultural analysis, they found that this visual content provides significant insights into local themes and consumers' activities (Hochman & Manovich, 2013).

Further research conducted a systematic literature review, which showed that most studies consider global social media skills, while only a few examine skill sets specific to a particular social media platform. The research recommends applying a glocalization approach, meaning thinking globally and acting locally in social media networks (Manca, Bocconi & Gleason, 2021).

Moreover, localized content significantly boosts a brand's visibility and reach in local search engine results (Nordhoff et al., 2018). By combining relevant local keywords, search engine optimization is one of the rewarding digital marketing strategies (Nagpal & Petersen, 2021).

Considering user experience, it has been demonstrated that a seamless, user-friendly experience is crucial for digital marketing success. Research has evaluated the interfaces of localized content in educational platforms and online courses and found a positive impact of culture on the interface design and user experience. Thus, localized content ensures enhanced user experience and engagement (Liu et al., 2020).

2.3 Content Marketing Measures

In the digital era, consumers are called users, and their behavior can be tracked qualitatively by big data, such as cookies, preferences, activeness, and engagement (Mills, 2019). The significant change in marketing in the digital era is integrating digital means and tools into the foundations of marketing.

According to the U&G Theory (Ruggiero, 2000), which focuses on the media user, the consumption of certain content depends on the extent to which this content satisfies the user's needs (Ruggiero, 2000). Furthermore, one of the challenges of marketers is to reach the target customers with worthy content that not only meets their needs and desires but also lets them be co-creators of the content by increasing their engagement.

There are two types of content: user-generated content, in which users participate in the creation through their comments and reviews, and brand-generated content, which the organization generally creates and distributes (Dennhardt, 2013).

A range of studies have explored the measurement of digital marketing content. Maintz and Zaumseil (2019) and Rancati and Gordini (2014) both provide comprehensive overviews of content marketing metrics. Maintz focuses on web analytics tools and data privacy implications, while Rancati examines the use and effectiveness of these metrics in Italian firms. Koiso-Kanttila (2004) offers a broader perspective, discussing the unique characteristics of digital content and their implications for marketing activities.

One of the standard content measures is the engagement rate. It is defined as the level of interactions between consumer and brand as manifested in cognitive affective and behavioral responses beyond the purchase (So et al., 2016). In the digital context, specifically on the Instagram platform, user engagement is calculated based on the number of likes, comments, and the profile's followers.

The literature well discusses the relationship between digital content and engagement rate. Rodgers and Thorson (2018) and Beng and Ming (2020) both highlight the impact of content type on engagement, with the former focusing on advertising and the latter on social media. Zhou et al. (2021) introduce a method for detecting engagement with digital content based on user experiences and higher-order goals. These studies collectively highlight the need for a nuanced understanding of digital content and its role in driving engagement.

Considering the desirability measure, range of studies have discussed the desirability of digital content, with a focus on its value and impact (Franklin & Plum, 2008), the determinants of its adoption in academic settings (Hidayat-ur-Rehman et al., 2020), its role in consumer satisfaction in digital content marketing (Khandelwal, 2018), Video ratings (Kortum & Sullivan, 2010), and its characteristics, value, and flow (Kim, Oh & Shin 2010). These studies

suggest that digital content's desirability is influenced by various factors, including its compatibility, convenience, and self-efficacy (Hidayat-ur-Rehman, 2020), as well as its design, flow and structure (Kim, Oh 7 Shin, 2010).

2.4 User Experience

User experience refers to three main elements: a user interacts with a product or content and a measurable interested experience. It considers a broader view of individuals interacting with an item, including emotions, thoughts, and perceptions resulting from that interaction (Tullis et al., 2013). A responsive UX across devices ensures seamless interactions and consistent content quality with no concerns whether accessed from a desktop, iPad, or smartphone. Hartson and Pyla (2018) identified four components of the user experience: usability, usefulness, emotional impact, and meaningfulness. All these factors must be combined to deliver a well-designed user experience.

A range of factors contribute to an effective user experience in social media. Fanta and Ayman (2021) emphasize the importance of understanding customer experience, particularly in the context of different product types and purchase journey phases. Rauniar et al.,(2019) identify perceived value, social presence, interactivity, and trustworthiness as critical predictors of user engagement. Further research highlights the impact of content, context, and creator on user engagement, suggesting that analytics can help understand these relationships (Jaakonmäki, Muller & Brocke, 2017). In addition, UX helps to reduce bounce rates and increase conversion rates (Takeda & Hatakeyama, 2016). Thus, by optimizing UX, businesses retain visitors and increase engagement (Podmajersky,2019).

The efficiency of user experience is measured based on the number of clicks to accomplish specific actions (Tullis et al., 2013). In social media networks, page views, likes, or comments can be identified as actions to be measured.

2.5 Cultural Scene In Saudi Arabia

The cultural scene in Saudi Arabia is currently experiencing a decisive shift, marked by a surge of artistic initiatives and events. This shift is driven by Saudi Vision 2030 and the establishment of the Ministry of Culture in 2018.

Looking into the supply scale, according to the latest statistics, 306 businesses operate in cultural and creative activities in Saudi Arabia, including 117 businesses in Riyadh (Monshaat, 2023). These activities include art galleries, cultural organizations, and libraries.

One of the key cultural events in Saudi Arabia is Diriyah Biennale. The inaugural Diriyah Biennale, held in Riyadh, juxtaposed contemporary Saudi Arabia with China during the 1980s—a period when China faced a similar relaxation of social and legal restrictions—curated by Philip Tinari, the exhibition aimed to contextualize the unique energy of this moment of optimism and openness in Saudi Arabia. The biennial successfully bridged the Saudi context with parallels in other countries (Biennale.org.sa, 2024). Moreover, the opening of Hayy Jameel, a significant cultural center, further contributes to the kingdom's emergence from artistic isolation. With the support of the Saudi Ministry of Culture, Hayy Jameel provides a platform for contemporary art, exhibitions, and discourse (Hayyjameel.org, 2024). Also, Misk Art Week featured exhibitions and discussions, fostering dialogue and creativity (Miskartinstitute.org, 2024).

From a consumption perspective, statistics showed that 39% of Saudi individuals over 15 years old attended entertainment events in the last 12 months. Thirty percent of Saudi consumers said that they do not attend cultural events due to high costs, compared to 27% due to time restrictions. Additionally, 48% of Saudi individuals used smartphones and tablets to access cultural and entertaining content compared to other channels (STATS.GOV.SA, 2023). Moreover, the average monthly household expenditure on culture and recreation was 388 SAR in 2012, which reflects approximately 9% of total household monthly expenditures. However, consumer index price CPI statistics show that the relative importance of cultural and recreation products is 3.06% compared to other goods and services. The CPI showed that cultural products weighed 107 in 2024 compared to 105 in 2023, indicating a slight increase of 0.16%. (STATS.GOV.SA, 2024).

Accordingly, the last five years have been pivotal for Saudi Arabia's cultural landscape, as it embraces artistic expression and strategic moves toward local and international cultural engagement. So, culturally related content published by these online cultural venues and centers often includes daily posts of cultural activities, announcements, videos, interviews, live streams of workshops and lectures, and documentation of their activities.

3. Theoretical Framework

3.1 Research Model

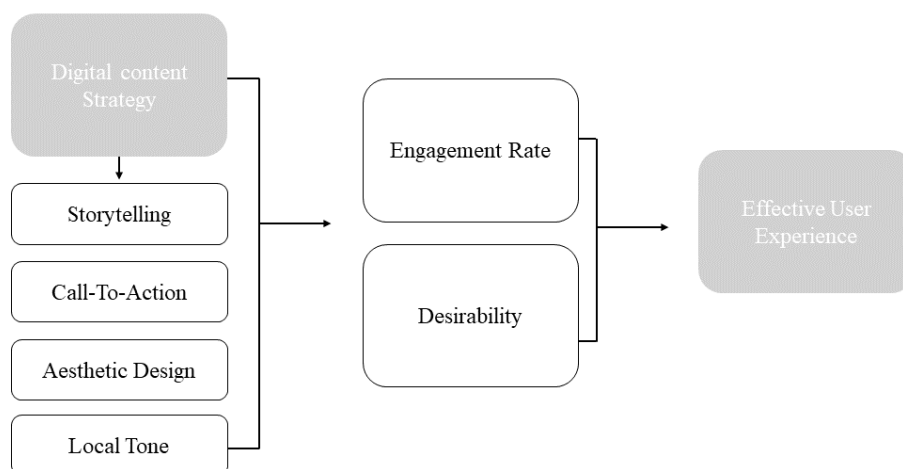


Figure 1: Research model, proposed by the researcher

Research Question

What Are The Determinants Of Effective Digital Content Strategy On User Experience Engagement Towards Cultural Venues? In other words, What Is The Role Of Different Digital Content Tactics On The User Experience Of Culturally Related Content?

4. Research Methodology

4.1 Research Design

This research applies qualitative content analysis (QCA), which describes the meaning of qualitative materials by setting a coding frame (Schreier, 2012). This method helps to focus on specific aspects of the collected data.

Moreover, this research follows the inductive approach, which involves moving from specific observations or data to broader generalizations or theories. In this case, starting with data collection and then analyzing patterns, identifying themes, and deriving theories or hypotheses is the foundation of this adopted approach (Rothchild, 2006). Hence, this bottom-up way, where insights emerge from the data, is considered an appropriate approach for the nature of this research.

4.2 Sampling Framework

According to the latest statistics, there are a total number of 306 businesses operating in cultural and creative activities in Saudi Arabia, including 117 businesses in Riyadh (Monshaat, 2023). In qualitative research, determining the appropriate sample size can depend on various factors as the research design, the specific research questions and the resources available.

For content analysis, researchers often use a purposeful or theoretical sampling approach, where the selection is made based on specific content being analysed relating to cultural content and the research question being addressed (Maison, 2018). So, the goal is to include enough data to thoroughly explore the topic and achieve data saturation, where new data no longer yield additional insights. In other words, more sampling may lead to redundancy, where the researcher reach to a clear correspondence between regularities and themes getting established (Carson, Gilmore & Perry, 2001). Overall, in qualitative research, the focus would be on the quality and depth of the data rather than the sample size.

However, the research has set six constructs to guide and direct the analysis process. First, four constructs related to content tactics were included: storytelling, call-to-action, aesthetics visual design, and localized content. Second, two constructs related to measuring user experience, engagement rate and sentiment analysis through the comments, were included.

According to the 10 times rule of sample size estimation, which is a guideline often used in Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) to determine the minimum sample size required for reliable results (Hair, Ringle, & Sarstedt, 2011), the expected sample size would be 60 profiles of cultural venues. In each profile, four posts will be analyzed, the top two engaged posts and the bottom two engaged posts. This will generate a total of 240 posts explored till the saturation point is reached from the gained data.

4.3 Data Collection Instrument

Instagram has been chosen to collect the data, as most representative sample are more digitally active there than on any other platform. Statistics showed that 72% of Internet users in Saudi Arabia use Instagram (Globalmediainsight, 2024). The researcher will track the online existence of the examined organizations, whether on the web or social media networks (Instagram), with the assistance of finding features similar to those provided by the Instagram application.

4.4 Content Analysis Techniques

Content analysis is one of the qualitative research methods used in marketing. The process includes coding the words into categories. These codes are usually determined by research

topics, which works as a starting point for the research. Further patterns may emerge from the collecting data process. (Carson, Gilmore & Perry · 2001).

Although it would be challenging to analyze the content of profiles that the researcher does not own or have limited access to, there are various tools facilitate the gain of insights. First is Path Social for Instagram, which allows the analysis of Instagram profiles. It provides many metrics, including engagement rate and most popular post-time. Second, Social Insider provides comprehensive Instagram analytics and explores engagement, reach, and content performance metrics. Third, Inflact is a profile analyzer that offers analytics for Instagram and other social media platforms, monitors metrics, tracks competitors and optimizes content strategy. These tools will assist the researcher in gaining insights regarding the best practices and effective content tactics that enhance user experience.

The collected data was stored in an Excel file for defining, organizing, classifying, and visualizing. Furthermore, the researcher conducted a qualitative analysis using MXDQA software. This German software specializes in content analysis and provides various tools, such as exploring words, coding, finding segments, analyzing documents, and generating themes and visual graphs. Finally, the researcher proposed a conceptual framework that includes the characteristics and elements of effective cultural content that enhance user experience.

5. Findings

Findings showed that cultural venue profiles are applying different digital content tactics. These profiles have been categorized into three types based on the organic engagement rate: high-engaging profiles, medium-engaging profiles, and lastly, low-engaging profiles. Descriptive statistics showed that 21 profiles were considered high-engaging profiles with more than a 4.5 engaging rate, followed by 12 medium-engaging profiles. Lastly, there were 27 low-engaging profiles with a percentage of less than 2.0% engagement rate.

Table 1: Descriptive Data of the analysed profiles

Number of profiles	Organic Engagement rate	Category type
21	More than 4.5%	High Engaging
12	4.0 - 2.0 %	Medium Engaging
27	Less than 2.0%	Low Engaging

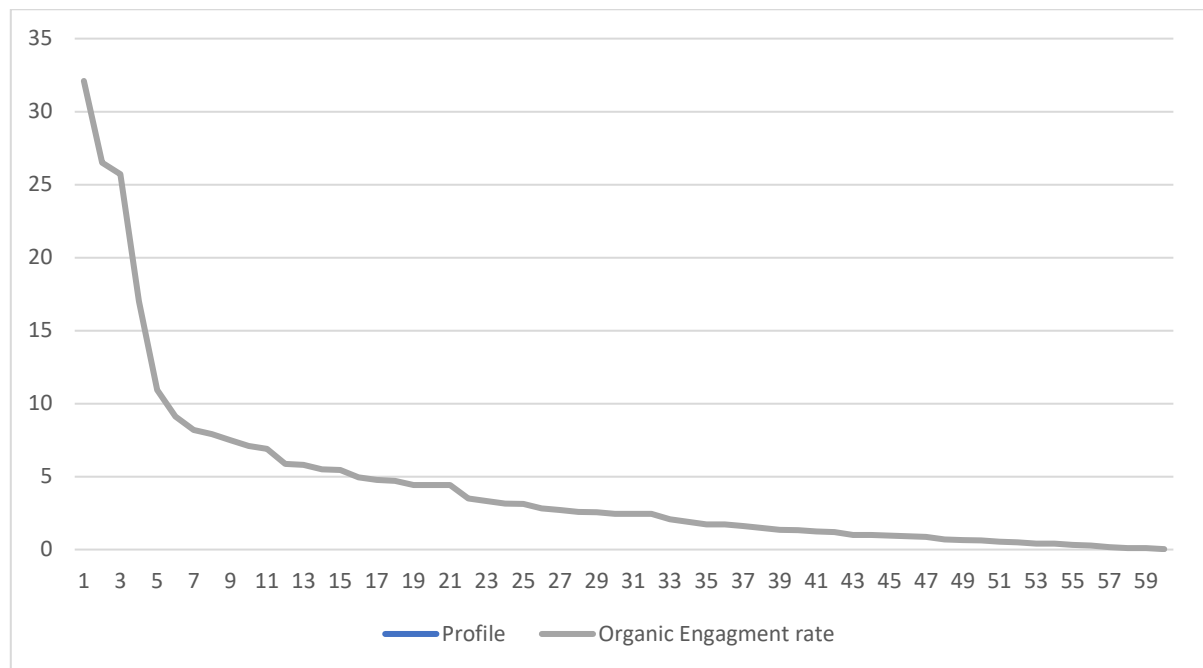


Figure 2: Distribution of profiles' engagement

Furthermore, findings show that there are common digital content tactics that the cultural venues have adapted. These are Call-to-Action, Aesthetic design, Storytelling, and the use of local tone, as shown in Figure 3 & Figure 4.



Figure 3: Document portrait of the raw data

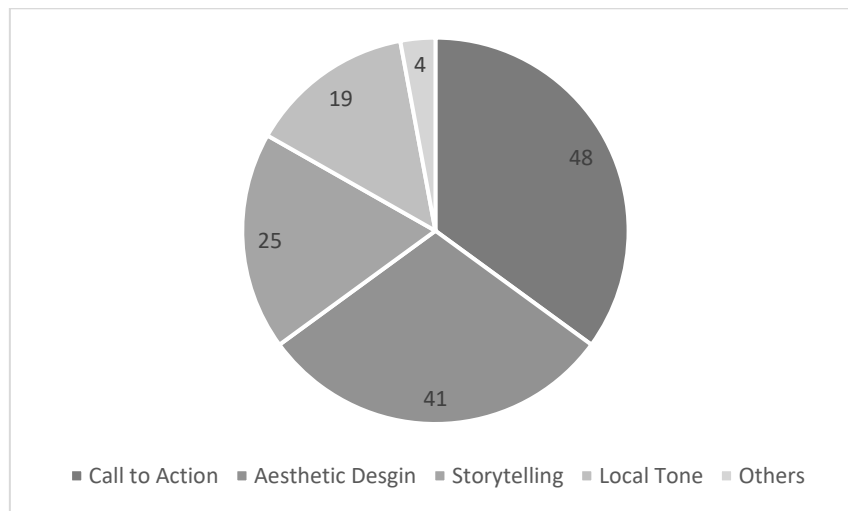


Figure 4: Types of digital content tactics that are used

The most adapted content tactic is Call-to-Action, with a percentage of 48%, Aesthetic design, with a percentage of 41%, Storytelling, with a percentage of 25%, and the use of local tone, with a percentage of 19%. Other content tactics that have been noticed are different attention grabbers, such as asking questions and including a quote in the post. Figure 4 demonstrates the correlation between the category of profiles and the most effective content applied.

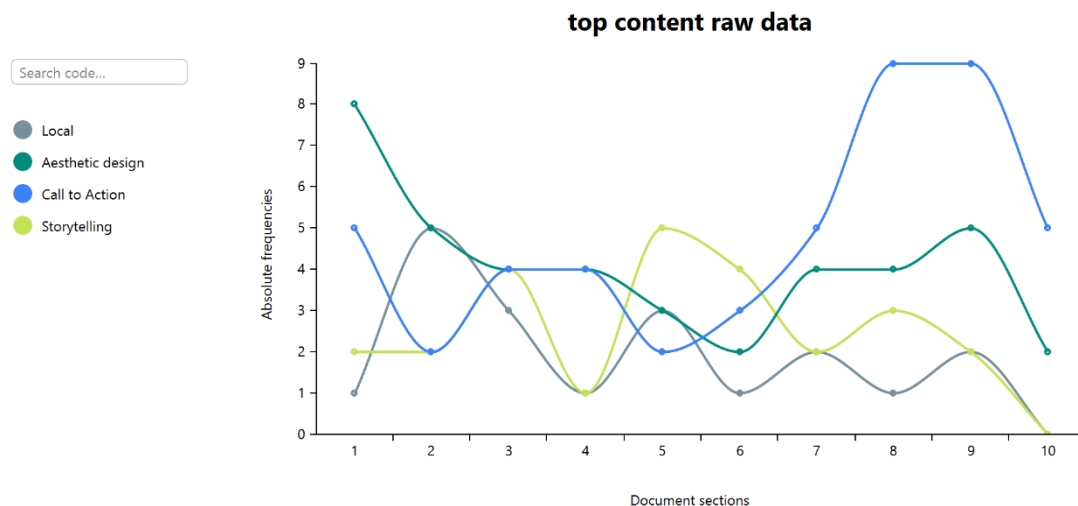


Figure 5: Code trends of the most used effective content tactics

Figure 5 illustrates that profiles with a high engagement rate usually implement aesthetic design content with a local tone and rare use of storytelling tactics. Medium-engaging profiles were found to apply storytelling tactics. On the other hand, low-engaging profiles are more likely to implement call-to-action tactics with limited use of local tone.

In contrast, the bottom low engagement contents were found to include adverts, cooperative work, and greetings for national and religious occasions.

As qualitative research, this research focuses on providing a rich, detailed understanding of the digital marketing content strategy and its developments. Thus, the research is conducted consistently and rigorously to ensure its trustworthiness.

First is credibility, which measures the truth value of the research. The researcher ensures that the study's findings are correct and accurate. Prolonged engagement with data and persistent observation are procedures that are used to increase the credibility of the current study. The second is confirmability, which refers to the degree to which the results could be confirmed or corroborated by others. This will be elaborated on in the following discussion section. Moreover, thick description is the third strategy used to ensure trustworthiness. This involves providing enough context in the description of the findings so that the conclusions drawn are transferable to other settings and situations. Finally, the Saturation point, where data collected do not generate new or relevant information with respect to the newly constructed theory (Ahmed,2024), is taken into consideration.

Therefore, the goal of the current research as a qualitative approach is not to generalize findings but to provide a rich, detailed understanding of a phenomenon regarding the effective digital content strategy of cultural activities.

6. Discussion

Based on the previous findings, this study has provided critical insights regarding the different digital content strategies for culturally related activities on social media platforms. As this research has delved into the discussion of effective digital content strategies concerning culturally related content, it is crucial to notice that there are distinct digital content methods that affect how users engage with and interact with it. This research's exploration is rooted in the understanding that culturally related content, as a complex social construct, significantly influences how audiences interact with and interpret digital content.

In this era of globalization and digital connectivity, content creators and strategists are presented with both opportunities and challenges. On one hand, they have the potential to reach a global audience; on the other hand, they must navigate the intricate web of cultural nuances to ensure the design of their content resonates with audiences desires.

The discussion section will dissect the strategies that have proven effective in creating and disseminating culturally related content. We will explore how these strategies have been utilized to foster engagement, drive conversations, and build communities. Furthermore, we will examine the role of the organization's maturity stages and their determinants in shaping effective digital content strategies. This discussion aims not only to shed light on what works but also to stimulate thought and inspire innovation in the realm of digital content creation.

First, findings show that cultural venues have adapted common digital content tactics. These are Call-to-Action, Aesthetic design, Storytelling, and the use of local tone. Regarding the Call-to-action method, 48% of posts being analysed were applied it. This method usually leads to higher engagement in low-engaging profiles. This could be interpreted as meaning that despite the fact that these kinds of profiles have not reached a stage of maturity in engagement and building an involving community, CTA is considered a cost-effective method for them. It includes easy components and can increase traffic. That's why they apply straightforward marketing messages, including posts about cultural workshops, events, and information about registration. These posts did not include intensive design elements and attention grabbers, and

they only invited the audience to take action. However, CTA posts gained more engagement from users, including likes and desirable comments. This result is supported by a number of studies that consistently emphasize that CTA can drive engagement in social media networks (Moran, Muzellec & Johnson, 2020; Shilovsky, 2021). Additionally, further study confirmed that a set of CTA links was associated with student engagement (Iraj et al., 2020). Nevertheless, it is suggested that a very strong CTA, usually a graphic CTA embedded directly in the article text, be included to drive people into converting. This emphasizes the importance of having a clear CTA to guide users toward taking the desired action after engaging with the content (Gupta, 2015).

Aesthetically designed content was the second adopted approach among the 240 posts that were analyzed, with a percentage of 41%. The findings of this research showed that these posts included different aesthetical and artistic elements in terms of colors, patterns, contrast, proportion, and typography type. Since aesthetics is an integral content principle that focuses on a design's pleasing qualities, the results of this research found that it has a crucial role in driving engagement. This is aligned with several studies in the literature, which highlight how aesthetic elements can enhance user experience and consequently increase engagement. More specifically, the consumers' aesthetic value is considered a key driver of social media use, as it generates responses (Aljukhadar, Poirier, & Senecal, 2020).

Additionally, it has been established that content aesthetic quality affects customer engagement in terms of boosting brand (Bazi, Filieri & Gorton, 2023). However, the results of this research showed that high-engaging profiles are commonly adopted in this type of digital content. This may be due to their high effectiveness in attracting and catching the eye of users and less consuming time to browse and view compared to other methods. Also, this content requires a graphic design team or a professional designer that have a good understanding of audience tastes, preferences, design trends, and techniques. Thus, high-engaging profiles are more capable of recruiting and integrating sources and efforts to deliver such aesthetically pleasant and engaging content.

Storytelling methods obtained a percentage of 25% among the examined posts. Medium-engaging profiles were the most applied storytelling methods in their content strategy. It found that storytelling generates not only considerable comments and likes but also creates conversations and extended discussions. It is considered a user-generated content, where posts motivate people to talk and share their ideas. It includes creative process videos, where crafts and hands-on creativity works are captured and documented step by step, inspiring viewers to contemplate. Some of the comments described it as a spiritual journey that is intuitive and experimental. The results of this research are consistent with various studies in the literature regarding the impact of story content on engagement. Kemp et al. (2021) and Dessart & Pitardi (2019) both highlight the positive relationship between story content and emotional connection, with the latter emphasizing the role of the story plot, characters, and verisimilitude in triggering cognitive, emotional, and behavioral responses.

A further study showed that digital video storytelling ads are more effective in hooking viewers and generating positive digital engagement compared to argumentative ads (Coker, Flight & Baima, 2021). Therefore, although this method takes longer to be produced, copywritten, edited, and then viewed and consumed than other methods, it is important for medium-engaging profiles to apply this method due to its ability to generate conversation and, therefore, boost engagement and enhance user experience.

The last method to be discussed is the use of local tone, which gained a percentage of 19% among the examined posts. Although the percentage was the lowest, it was one of the effective methods adopted by high-engaging profiles after aesthetic design. When content speaks directly to the local audience, it conveys authenticity in meeting their needs (Mehta, 2020), fostering trust over time. It has been established that localized social media use driven by social motivations significantly affects interpersonal trust and local participation (Kwon, Shao & Nah, 2020). This finding is supported by research.

Considering user experience, it has been demonstrated that a seamless, user-friendly experience is crucial for digital marketing success. Research has evaluated the interfaces of localized content in educational platforms and online courses and found a positive impact of culture on the interface design and user experience. Thus, localized content ensures enhanced user experience and engagement (Liu et al., 2020).

A noticeable result showed that only high-engaging profiles use local tone in their content method, whereas low-engaging profiles do not show adoption of it. This indicates the high effectiveness of localized voice in delivering inviting and engaging content.

7. Conclusions

In conclusion, this research has underscored the pivotal role that digital marketing content strategy plays in enhancing user experience towards cultural venues in Saudi Arabia. It has been established that a well-crafted digital marketing content strategy not only motivates comments, likes, and shares but also enhances and enriches their online experience of these cultural venues.

The study revealed that digital content that is inviting, aesthetically appealing, and tells a story in a local tone can significantly influence users' overall engagement. It has also highlighted the importance of utilizing various digital content methods to reach the target audience with an immersive and interactive experience.

Moreover, the research has shed light on Saudi Arabia's unique cultural context and how digital marketing strategies and content creators should be tailored to resonate with the local audience. It has emphasized the need for cultural venues to continuously innovate and adapt different digital content strategies to meet users' needs and expectations. These methods include CTA, Aesthetic design, storytelling, and localization. They have the potential to boost engagement and enhance the implementation of the digital marketing strategy.

The role of digital marketing content strategy is not just about promoting cultural venues in Saudi Arabia but about creating a meaningful user experience that fosters a deeper appreciation of the country's rich cultural heritage. This, in turn, can contribute to Saudi Arabia's cultural and tourism development, reinforcing its position as a vibrant cultural destination on the global map.

7.1 Implications

This research's findings have important implications for cultural venues, digital marketers, content creators, and social media developers in Saudi Arabia. They underscore the need for continuous investment in digital marketing and the development of user-centric and culturally relevant content strategies that enhance the digital experience overall.

7.2 Limitations & Future Research

Qualitative research and content analysis-based research, while valuable, do have certain limitations. First, in terms of subjectivity, the researcher's own biases and interpretations can influence the analysis and results. However, the researcher made efforts to link the findings with previous research to support and present a solid foundation. Furthermore, the richness of the collected data may lead to data overload, making it challenging to manage and analyze the data. The researchers worked on three different platforms to ensure the accuracy of social media metrics, especially since some of the analyzed cases were inactive. Despite these limitations, this research provides deep insights and an understanding of a phenomenon in a specific market reflected in culturally related content.

Since current research focuses on content-related factors, future research can consider combining quantitative analysis and examining different consumer-related factors affecting preferences, engagements, and cultural consumer experience. Moreover, it is recommended that future research be conducted regarding the creative process in social media and virality. The paper also calls for further research in this area to keep pace with the rapid advancements in digital marketing.

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